University of Michigan
Fall 2026 Midterm Instructor Report
EECS 110-001: Discover CS
Madelyn Gatchel

11 out of 14 students responded to this midterm evaluation.

Responses to questions related to the course:

	SA	A	N	D	SD	N/A	Median
I am learning a great deal in this course. (Q966)	7	3	1	0	0	0	4.71

Responses to questions related to the instructor:

	SA	A	N	D	SD	N/A	Median
Madelyn Gatchel is enthusiastic. (Q114)	11	0	0	0	0	0	5.00
Overall, this is an excellent course. (Q964)	10	1	0	0	0	0	4.95
Overall, Madelyn Gatchel is an excellent teacher. (Q965)	8	3	0	0	0	0	4.81
Madelyn Gatchel acknowledges all questions insofar as possible. (Q968)	11	0	0	0	0	0	5.00
Madelyn Gatchel uses techniques to foster class participation. (Q972)	7	4	0	0	0	0	4.71
Madelyn Gatchel is willing to meet and help students outside class. (Q975)	9	2	0	0	0	0	4.89
Madelyn Gatchel keeps students informed of their progress. (Q977)	8	2	1	0	0	0	4.81

Written Comments

What are the major strengths of this class? What is helping you to learn? (Q979)

Comments
The setup of the class allows for ample understanding of the course concepts. Beginning class with lecture and concluding with the lab component aids students in staying engaged, and the homework follows the concepts presented in lecture well.
EECS 110 gave me great exposure on real–world & interdisciplinary CS. I get the opportunity to see how computing applies across many fields such as science, social science, art, and engineering etc. instead of only pure textbook programming.
Besides all the memorizing and reading, there is a lot of hands on activities that help with learning
Madelyn give ample time to complete assignments and opportunties ot resubmit and try again, which creates an environment inviting of making mistakes and learning from your mistakes.
I think class is very helpful providing the basics of python programming. The labs are thoughtful and helpful to make me think about the topics.
In–class labs really help to lock in content.
A major strength of this course is Madelyn's enthusiasm for the subject matter. As a student who did not have programming experience, her enthusiasm is contagious and makes learning computer science really exciting. She is very knowledgable and inclusive, and she is the kind of instructor who truly cares for her students and their personal learning. She is very kind and is always more than happy to answer questions.
The major strength is Madelyn Gatchel as she always shows up and is willing to provide a lot of assistance. It helps me to learn when she breaks down the concept during office hours and helps me with approaching to the problems. Overall, it's a really good environment that makes me want to keep trying every day.
Participation and also working in groups in labs.
Madelyn is an expert

How can Madelyn Gatchel improve this class? If possible, give specific examples. (Q980)

Comments
The only specific thing I could think to improve the class is rotating lab groups so that students are able to collaborate with other classmates and learn from those who are stronger in certain areas.
Professor Gatchel is an outstanding teacher. She consistently goes out of her way to help students who struggle with Python syntax, and her caring attitude sets a fantastic tone for our lab group work. I deeply appreciate her guidance. If I could suggest some way to enhance the experience for new programmers like me. For example, short pre–lab guides or 5–10 minute introductory clips for each new programming topic would let students preview unfamiliar syntax ahead of time. Since many of us have no prior coding background, this would reduce anxiety and let our in–class group time focus more on exploration rather than just catching up on basic ideas.
After explaining a concept give more examples so the idea fully makes sense
The course tends to be a little bit on the easier simpler side.
More opportunities for homework help
Even though I think collaboration can be important, one thing I would like is to have individual labs or the flexibility to choose to work alone or with a group. Alternatively, the potential to rotate lab groups so students can get to know other students in class, which could maintain the collaborative nature of the assignments while allowing for flexibility. Other than that, I think this class is really great!
During office hours, she really helps in giving advice to succeed in class and is always willing to help with a positive attitude.
I like the way the class is set up now
Don’t worry about offering help too often

Please enter any additional comments you have for Madelyn Gatchel. (Q981)

Comments
Professor Gatchel went the extra mile to help me work through basic Python syntax whenever I got stuck on coding exercises. I truly appreciate her guidance with my homework and our in–class lab group work. She is an excellent teacher! I learned so much from her, not only about core computer science concepts, but also about being helpful and supportive toward others.
She is really kind and inspiring. She has made this class a really positive experience for me. I am happy to have taken this class, but most importantly, to have an instructor like her during my time here.
None, she is amazing.
Nope
N/A